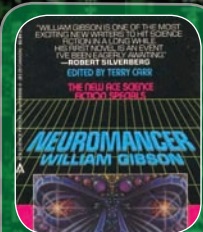


Geek culture : Hackers

You don't need to be able to count in hexadecimal or hang out at dubious IRC channels to be a hacker. On the other hand, if you can break the encryption on your daddy's WEP wireless security, you are still not a hacker. It's about the eagerness to learn everything your machine can do, rather than knowing just enough to serve your immediate purposes.

Books



Neuromancer: This 1984 book is the source of AI and Virtual Reality awareness in popular culture.



Stealing the Network: Fiction with screenshots of hacks, sci-fi cannot get better than this.



Zero-Day Exploit: Lessons in safety for network admins, using technical fictional scenarios.

Movies



Hackers: A classic black hat - white hat struggle, epitomising the crash and burn attitude. A must watch.



Ghost in the Machine: A dead body comes alive in a network, one of the cheesiest tech films made.



Tron: A hacker is abducted into cyberspace where he has to fight to survive. A sequel is in the offing.

Gear



Black hat - A black hat that says "black hat" from hackerstickers.com. Even a n00b will get the point.



The apparel section of the thinkgeek store has this AYB T-shirt. Take off every Zig!



Tokyoflash sells a range of geeky watches, the Tibida requires you to know binary to tell time.

==Digit Diary==

Ahmed decided to conduct some particle collision experiments of his own, and managed to bump into an autorickshaw. Witnesses claim that a small cluster of higg's bosons were released, but were unfortunately not recorded, so the information cannot be confirmed.

Rohan Naravane joined the test centre this month, and jumped right in with the netbook tests. He has as yet not been tested against the team in a Quake 3 tournament, but we will keep you posted on the developments.

There seems to be a strange poltergeist loose in our office. The Caps Lock, Num Lock, and Insert keys seem to be the primary targets, causing a lot of frustration. Edward was particularly irked, when he sat down on Robert's machine and found that he had been Num Locked. If any of you have ghost-busting skills, or are haunted by a similiar spirit, do write in to editor@thinkdigit.com.

Mirror's Edge in Flash

Couldn't get your hands on the first person parkour adventure? No problem, all you need is a browser to play an official Flash version of this innovative game. Just because it is all in Flash does not mean that it is easy. There are also leaderboards for that multiplayer element. It's a lengthy game, but your progress is automatically saved, so you can revisit. Head over to <http://www.mirrorsedge2d.com>.



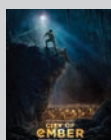
1337sp33k

Stay up to date with internet lingo, so you don't wt? the next time you are chatting with someone

KTHXBAI: Typically used to haul butt in a hurry, when you want to get out of an unpromising conversation. It is a word that combines Ok, thank you, and bye into one powerful expression.

gg no re: Used when you have been totally owned in an online multiplayer scenario. Stands for Good Game, No Re-match, which means you are chickening out.

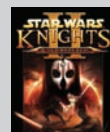
How we unwind



Movies
City of Ember: A great 2008 sci-fi flick where kids from an underground buried city discover a world outside.



Music
Pigs and Pyramids: A Pink Floyd tribute album which had some refreshing covers, and a few horrible ones.



Game
KOTOR II: The team re-visited this old roleplaying game because of the unending variety of ways the game can be played.